after the auction, and US$1.1 million appeared beside my name.

I made my debut for RCB at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium against the newly formed Kochi Tuskers Kerala, one of two new franchises whose introduction had increased the number of teams from eight to 10, and I managed to score an unbeaten 54 from 40 balls, including five sixes, as we reached our target of 162 to win the game. I was pleased to be named Man of the Match.

This was the season when the value of momentum became clear. Having won our first match, we proceeded to lose the next three and the fifth was a no-result. We were struggling but nobody panicked and we managed to win the next seven games in succession, eventually finishing top of the league.

Moving to the knockout stages, we lost to CSK in the first qualifier between the first and second placed teams, but recovered to beat Mumbai Indians in the second qualifier when Chris Gayle, the hard-hitting West Indian batsman who had joined us as an injury replacement for Dirk Nannes, produced a typically brutal knock, scoring 89 from 47 balls. RCB advanced to play CSK again, this time in the IPL final at Chennai.

We were ready to perform on the big day but the CSK openers, Mike Hussey and Murali Vijay, scored 159 in fewer than 15 overs, and we actually did well to restrict them to 205 for five.

It was going to be a tough chase, and we had the worst possible start when Chris was out in the first over. We continued to lose wickets, with Virat Kohli dismissed for 35 and me scoring only 18, and we were essentially out of the running at 70 for six in the 11th over. CSK duly claimed a second title.

Chris Gayle, Virat Kohli and I had been assembled as the core of the RCB batting order, and we would stay together for six IPL tournaments, enjoying many great days, many fine partnerships, entertaining electric capacity crowds of 45 000 flag-waving supporters at the Chinnaswamy Stadium in Bengaluru.